VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

Rise of Dictatorship

Lecture 01

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Topics *to be covered*

1. Factors → Fascism.

Fascism-Causes, Aims and Impact





Bajega Jab
Yo Yo Wala
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Rise of Dictatorship

- In the decade after the First World War (1919 to 1929), democracy made remarkable progress all over the world.

- This did not last long and dictatorships established under different names and forms in Russia, Italy, Germany and Spain.

- These countries 'dictated' controlled the total behavior of their citizens. Everywhere these countries threatened their neighboring countries.

Dictatorship Countries Be Like





Rise of Dictatorship

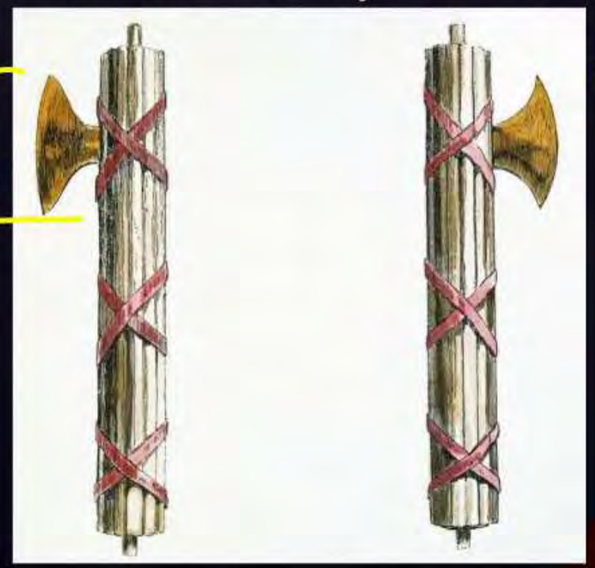
1. They refused to work with the League of Nations except on their own terms.

2. Their motto was "everything for the State, everything within the State and nothing outside the State."

3. During this period, even in democratic countries, some people favoured dictatorship.

FASCISM

- The word 'Fascism' has been derived from the Italian word fascio which means union or league.
- It also refers to the ancient Roman symbol of power; the fasces was a bundle of sticks bound to an axe that symbolised civic unity and the authority of Roman officials to punish wrongdoers.



Which symbol was associated with Roman authority and later adopted by Mussolini?

(A) Swastika

(B) Fasces (bundle of rods with an axe)

(C) Hammer and sickle

(D) Olive branch



FASCISM

- 'Fascism' means autocracy or dictatorship where the power of the State is in the hands of one man only; and it is obligatory for all the others to obey his orders.

- Fascism was an intensely nationalistic, anti-communistic and anti-democratic movement which served as a model to dictatorial regimes in Italy and Germany.



CAUSES FOR THE RISE OF FASCISM

- Fascism emerged as a movement in the post World War I period not only to meet the challenges of the international communist movement but also to tackle the various problems that confronted Italy. The following factors contributed to the rise of Fascism in Italy:

1. Discontentment after the Treaty of Versailles

↳ Unsatisfication

- Italy joined the Allies in the First World War to gain territories of Turkey and Germany.
- But by the Treaty of Versailles, she could get only Southern Tyrol and Trentino, and the Coastal Regions of Dalmatia. She could get no part of the German and Turkish colonial empire.





2. Economic Crisis:

- Italy suffered heavy losses in terms of life and property in the First World War.
- After the War, many soldiers became unemployed.
- Trade and commerce were ruined leading to large-scale unemployment. There was a shortage of food grains.



3. Political Instability:

- Democracy was introduced in Italy for the first time in 1919. Elections failed to give a clear majority to a single party.

- As a result, there was complete instability in the country and between 1919 and 1922 six coalition governments were formed in Italy.

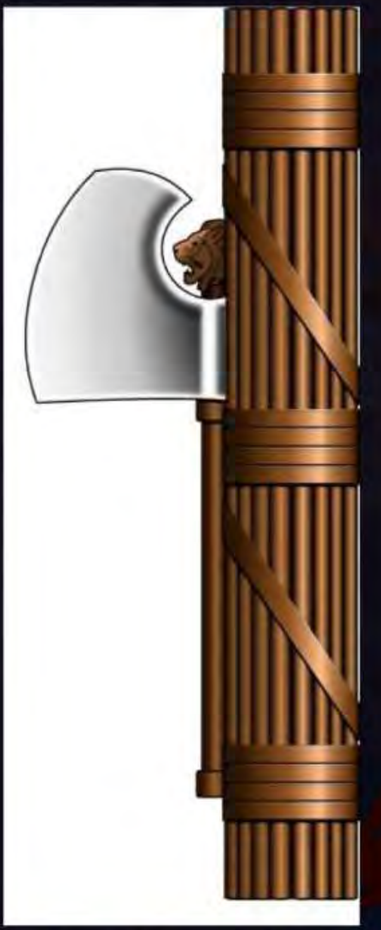
- The various political parties had different policies and programmes and there was no continuity in their policies.

3. Political Instability:

- They were unable to deal effectively with the problems of unemployment, strikes and riots which took place during 1921-22.

violent fights

- This situation was fully exploited by the Fascists under the leadership of Mussolini, who promised the people a strong national government.



The Fasces



4. Class Conflicts:

- Class conflict increased in many countries after the First World War.
- The real issue in most parts of continental Europe was whether control of government and economic systems would continue to be controlled by aristocracies or would be in the hands of less privileged majorities.
- The common man had been promised, during the War, that he would be rewarded by greater attention to his economic needs. These promises were ignored



5. Threat of Socialism or Communism:

- The Socialists who included the Anarchists, the Communists and the Social Democrats created conditions supportive to the growth of Fascism in Italy.

- Inspired by the Russian Revolution, the Communists filled the atmosphere with revolutionary ideas.

- Peasants took away the land from landlords; workmen organised strikes, damaged machines and took hold of the factories.



5. Threat of Socialism or Communism:

- The communists began to devise new plans of overthrowing the government and capturing power.

- People wanted a powerful leadership who could establish peace and prosperity by ending lawlessness and insecurity in Italy.

- The industrialists saw the growing strength of the labour unions with alarm and provided financial support to Fascism.



6. Failure of the League of Nations:

- After the First World War, the League of Nations was established to maintain peace in the world and to prevent wars.

- But it proved weak and failed to achieve its aims. It failed to check the rise of dictatorships.

- Had it acted well in time, the ambitious plans of Mussolini and Hitler would not have been successful

League Of Nations Be Like



7. Leadership Provided by Mussolini:

- Mussolini played an important role in the history of Italy. He had a charismatic personality.

- His speeches praised the past glories of Italy and won the faith of his countrymen. Mussolini was called 'Duce' which means the Leader



Who was called the 'Duce' meaning the 'Leader'?

(A) Adolf Hitler

(B) Mussolini

(C) King Victor Emmanull II

(D) King Victor Emmanull III

What country did Mussolini lead?

(A) Italy

(B) Germany

(C) France

(D) The United Kingdom

AIMS OF FASCISM

The main aims of Fascism were the following:

(i) Fascism was the opposite of democracy. Fascists believed that democracy was not suitable for the country because it increases the gap between the poor and the rich





AIMS OF FASCISM

(ii) Fascists supported one party and one leader. They believed that the country could make progress only under one leader. According to the Fascists, dictatorship was the best form of government. That is why Mussolini said, "All parties must end, must fall. I want to see a panorama of ruins around me, the ruins of the other political forces so that Fascism may stand gigantic and dominant."



AIMS OF FASCISM

(iii) Fascists favoured equal control over all sections of society. They wanted to control capitalists, industrialists, labourers, landlords, peasants and artisans.

(iv) Fascists laid stress on nationalism and not on individual institutions.

(v) They believed that the interests of the State must get priority over individual interests because an individual gets all the rights from the State.



AIMS OF FASCISM

(vi) Fascists regarded quality more important than quantity and therefore, opposed that form of democracy which compares a nation to the majority.

(vii) The Fascist leaders who had the will, sentiments and emotions of people were symbols of a nation's pride.

AIMS OF FASCISM

(viii) Fascists favoured aggressive foreign policy and regarded war as an instrument for promoting national interest.

is the only Solution



Benito Mussolini

Mussolini's Fascism mainly glorified the _____, whereas Hitler's Nazism glorified the _____.

(A) Individual; State

(B) Church; Pope

(C) State; Race

(D) League of Nations; Democracy

The “March on Rome” refers to:

(A) Hitler’s attempt to overthrow the Weimar Republic

(B) Mussolini’s Fascist march to seize power

(C) Italy’s participation in World War I

(D) A peace march after World War I



Homework From VICTORY Module

2 Causes for rise of fascism.


Thank You